



Code: DJ-AR
Revised/Reviewed: 7/21/21

Expenditure of Funds for Meals, Refreshments and Gifts

HCCS recognizes there may be occasions when it is appropriate for Board members, administrators and others to expend school funds in the course of conducting HCCS business to provide meals or refreshments (bakery goods, snacks, fruit, punch, coffee, tea, soft drinks, etc.). The purchase of gifts may also be approved, in certain situations. Such occasions may include, but are not limited to, various school meetings, gatherings to celebrate school successes or recognize individual achievements, contributions or outstanding service to the school and other school-sponsored activities. Such expenditures may be made with prior administrator/principal approval only, subject to the provisions of this administrative regulation.

The use of HCCS funds, as used in this regulation, means the use of money in any of the general accounts of the school. Exceptions are funds collected from staff members or others for the specific purpose of providing gifts or parties. It is also recognized that the school may have established a “social fund” or “sunshine fund” to which each staff member may voluntarily contribute. Such funds are generally used for birthday recognition, bereavement and illness acknowledgment activities, etc. These funds are also exempt from the following requirements.

Meals and Refreshments

HCCS funds may be used to pay for individual or group meals only if official school business is being conducted during the time in which the meal is provided and only if the meal provides a particularly practical time or setting for the discussion, consistent with Board policy and the following:

1. Meals may be provided by the school to recognize the contributions of staff, through retirement dinners or other recognition events;
2. Meals may be provided by the school as a part of Board or administrative work sessions, at school committee meetings or other school-approved activities.

Meals not directly business related may be provided to staff or others at the individual’s expense only.

HCCS Board members and administrative staff may use school funds to provide refreshments for staff, parents or others at meetings, in-service programs or other similar school-sponsored activities, not to exceed \$15 per participant and subject to the following additional requirements:

1. The \$15 limit per participant is not inclusive of gratuity. Gratuity is limited to 15 percent of the total cost;
2. The purchase of alcoholic beverages with school funds is strictly prohibited;
3. The use of school monies for parties is prohibited.

Gifts

There are numerous occasions that may arise whereby Board members, administrators or other school staff may feel the need to recognize employees (i.e., Administrative Professional's Day, employees' week, birthday, etc. A HCCS Board member, administrator or other school employee may provide such recognition only at their expense, unless as otherwise permitted below:

1. The school may provide a small token of appreciation for a Board member's or employee's retirement and years of service and other related activities using school funds, as approved in advance.
2. Administrators may use school funds to provide an appropriate token of appreciation on behalf of the Board. The value of this item may not exceed \$50 per person;
3. No other expenditure of school monies for gifts is permitted without prior authorization from the administrator/principal or designee.